



No more Hangouts

Google Hangouts is to shut down completely before the end of this year.
<https://digit.in/aug22-39>

Nothing Phone (1) Essentially Everything

The Nothing Phone (1) is essentially everything that you expect from a mid-range smartphone that's out to disrupt the foundations of the smartphone ecosystem. It caters to the enthusiast crowd more so than anyone else.

Out to rekindle the fire in the smartphone world, does the Nothing Phone 1 even have enough fireworks to light its own path? Let's find out in this review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The design is one of the most divisive parts of the Nothing Phone 1. The back of the phone is transparent which would mean you can see through the phone and look at the internal components, except you cannot because the components are covered to make for an elegant look. Then there's the Glyph interface which lights up perfectly for calls or notification alerts, voice commands, and more.

Overall, the Nothing Phone 1 has a solid build quality and it feels very premium to hold in your hands. It's lightweight and has a wide aspect ratio which lets you enjoy watching movies or shows on that beautiful display with utmost ease.

DISPLAY

The display on the Nothing Phone 1 is a stunner offering vibrant colours with good contrast and clarity. Nothing claims 500 nits of typical brightness which in our tests peaked at 809 nits. It supports an adaptive 120Hz refresh rate. Also, there is an option to change the colour profile of the display as per your preference along with a manual colour temperature slider.

PERFORMANCE

The Snapdragon 778G+ under the hood powers through anything you throw at it, from multi-tasking or playing intensive games or daily tasks. The



software is smooth, bloat-free and fluid but not without its share of issues.

The on-screen fingerprint sensor works well and in real-world use, it unlocks the phone in the blink of an eye. As for the speakers, the stereo setup offers good sound quality but the bottom-firing speaker is louder than the front-firing one, giving an impression of an unbalanced sound profile. Another issue we found out with the speakers is the channel positioning when the phone is rotated in landscape mode. Ideally, the right and left channels should switch as the phone is rotated but it doesn't happen in Nothing's case. It can be fixed in the future with an OTA update.

CAMERAS

In this device, the main camera is capable of producing good-looking pictures that have plentiful details with good natural colours. Meanwhile, the ultra-wide camera is able to take wider landscape shots but is unable to preserve details along the edges and

four corners. The Phone 1 also uses the ultra-wide sensor to capture macro pictures which are pretty good and usable pictures which is something of a rarity in this budget segment.

Switching to night mode leads to better clarity and textures but there's also a lot of noise that creeps into the frame which doesn't bode well for the ultra-wide camera. The front-facing camera does a decent job of taking selfies so long as there's ample light falling on your face. Otherwise, it's a hit-and-miss affair.

BATTERY

The Nothing Phone (1) has a respectable battery size that will easily last you a day on a full charge. You will be able to get more out of this phone if you're a casual user but anywhere between medium to high power usage and you're looking at less than a day's worth of battery life.



BUILD & DESIGN.....77
FEATURES.....78
PERFORMANCE.....70
VALUE FOR MONEY...74

VERDICT

The Nothing Phone 1 is a value-for-money smartphone that doesn't beat around the bush and offers essentially everything that you'd need in a phone in 2022. It tries its best to be

a renegade but some of the OnePlus DNA still creeps through. If you are someone who's looking for a vastly different-looking Android phone, the Nothing Phone 1 is right up your alley. Otherwise, there are many other phones out in the market.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.55-inch AMOLED, FHD+, 120Hz refresh rate, HDR10+ | WEIGHT: 193.5g | PLATFORM: Qualcomm Snapdragon 778G+ | RAM: 8GB/12GB LPDDR5 | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 256GB UFS 3.1 | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: No | 5G SUPPORT: Yes | USB-C: Yes | 3.5MM JACK: No | OS: Nothing OS based on Android 12 | REAR CAMERA: 50MP (f/1.9), OIS + 50MP ultra-wide | FRONT CAMERA: 16MP (f/2.5) | SPEAKERS: Stereo speakers | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 4,500mAh, 33W wired, 15W wireless charging | COLOURS: Black, White

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